STEP 02 | Stakeholder Discovery & User Needs

Gather the information needed from support agents, managers, customers, administrators, and security stakeholders.

1. Stakeholder groups

- Support agents: need clear priorities, correct assignment, relevant case context, and manageable workloads.
- Support managers: need backlog, SLA risk, workload, escalation, and team performance visibility.
- Customers: need timely acknowledgement, updates, and appropriate handling of urgent issues.
- Salesforce administrators/product owners: need maintainable configuration, traceability, and safe deployment.
- IT/security/data owners: need controlled access, data minimization, retention, and AI governance.

2. Interview questions

- How are cases received today: web, email, phone, chat, messaging, or integrations?
- Who decides priority, and what criteria distinguish critical, high, normal, and low cases?
- Which SLA targets, business hours, customer tiers, products, and escalation policies apply?
- How are agent skills, language capabilities, availability, and workload maintained?
- What causes the most reassignments, delays, and customer complaints?
- Which case data is sensitive, and what must not be sent to an AI service?
- Which actions may be automatic, and which require approval?

3. Process observation

- Follow a sample case from creation through triage, assignment, first response, escalation, and resolution.
- Record handoffs, waiting time, duplicate work, exceptions, and manual decisions.
- Collect examples of urgent and non-urgent cases, including ambiguous descriptions.

4. Discovery outputs

- Stakeholder map and interview notes.
- Current-state process diagram.
- Approved priority definitions and routing criteria.
- List of required fields, integrations, reports, and controls.
- Baseline metrics for response time, SLA compliance, reassignment, and backlog.

5. Completion checklist

- Business owner confirms the problem statement.
- Support team validates the current workflow.
- Security/data owner confirms constraints.
- Open questions and assumptions are documented rather than silently guessed.

Project note: This is a proposed implementation guide. Validate Salesforce features, licensing, configuration, security requirements, and business policies in the target organization before implementation.